4.6 Acute Pulmonary Edema*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I am drowning." **Objective** • Pink, frothy sputum • Crackles throughout both lungs • SpO_2 84%, RR 36/min	**ACTUAL** Impaired gas exchange related to alveolar fluid accumulation as evidenced by hypoxemia, frothy sputum and crackles.	• SpO_2 94% or above within 1 hour.	• Sit her upright with the legs hanging down. • Give high-flow oxygen and prepare for CPAP as ordered. • Give the IV diuretic and nitrates as prescribed. • Keep SpO_2, BP and ECG on continuous monitoring. • Insert a urinary catheter to measure output if ordered.	• Achieved at target SpO_2 with easier breathing.
Subjective • Expresses intense fear **Objective** • Agitated • Sweating	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety related to severe dyspnea as evidenced by agitation and fear.	• Looks calmer as breathing improves.	• Stay with her. • Speak calmly and explain what you are doing. • Give the prescribed medication.	• Outcome reached when she is calmer.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • High-dose IV diuretic	**RISK** Risk for impaired water-electrolyte balance as evidenced by risk factors: rapid diuresis.	• Potassium and sodium stay normal during diuresis.	• Check potassium and sodium as ordered. • Watch the ECG for dysrhythmia. • Replace potassium as ordered. • Measure urine output hourly during IV diuresis.	• Considered met if electrolytes remain normal.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [33], [35], [128]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.